Writing Technique

Year 4 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Easy / Standard

1. C — personification (the wind is given the human action of whispering)
2. simile
3. alliteration (repeated 'b' sound in "busy bees buzzed by the bright blooms")
4. C — The moon was as bright as a torch (uses "as... as")
5. Example: "The sea heaved and crashed like a raging beast." (accept any valid simile using like/as)
6. onomatopoeia — "POP" imitates the actual sound, making the action vivid and immediate
7. "marched" — it shows how she walked (with confidence/purpose), more powerful and precise than the plain verb "walked"
8. A — Slippery snakes slithered silently (repeated 's' sound)
9. A and C (leaves "danced" and the sun "smiled" give human actions to non-human things; B and D are literal descriptions)
10. B — "The dog sprinted, ears flapping in the wind" — uses a more powerful verb and vivid detail, showing rather than just telling
11. onomatopoeia
12. Example: "She was a lion, fearless and strong." (accept any valid metaphor)
13. A — Quickly, she grabbed her bag (opens with an adverb for variety)
14. personification (the stars are given the human action of winking)
15. B and D ("trudged" and "sprinted" are precise, powerful verbs that show how the action was done; "walked" and "went" are plain, overused verbs)

Standard

16. A simile compares two things using 'like' or 'as' (e.g. "as brave as a lion"); a metaphor says one thing IS another, without 'like' or 'as' (e.g. "he was a lion").
17. A — The classroom was a zoo (states it IS a zoo, no "like" or "as")
18. Onomatopoeia — "hammered" imitates the sound of heavy rain, making the description more vivid and dramatic
19. Example: "She darted across the room." / "She dashed across the room." (accept any powerful, precise verb)
20. C — Tom's hands trembled as he gripped the microphone (shows the physical signs of nervousness rather than simply stating the emotion)
21. A and C (crackled, hissed, screeched all imitate real sounds; B and D are plain statements)
22. Example: "The storm howled and hurled rain against the windows."
23. B — alliteration (repeated 's' sound)
24. It creates more variety and builds tension/atmosphere by fronting the time clause, instead of the plain subject-first sentence
25. B — "Flames roared and devoured everything in their path" — uses powerful verbs and personification to create a vivid, dramatic image instead of the plain, generic description
26. Simile ("like tiny knives") and personification/a powerful verb ("bit into her feet" — giving the rocks a biting action)
27. A — Beneath the old oak tree, the children played (opens with a prepositional phrase)
28. A and C (both use a fronted adverbial/phrase for variety; B and D start with the plain subject)
29. Example: "She bounced on her toes, grinning from ear to ear." (accept any valid 'showing' sentence)
30. Personification — the house is given human actions (groaning, creaking) to make it feel alive and eerie

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Standard / Hard

31. Personification — the waves are given the human action of clapping, making them feel lively and almost cheerful.

32. A — 'like a wolf' is a simile and 'tore' gives the wind a human/animal action (personification).

33. Example: 'The boy punched the air and grinned from ear to ear.' (accept any valid showing rewrite)

34. An extended metaphor keeps the same comparison going across several sentences, not just one — e.g. describing a classroom as a 'zoo' and continuing with words like 'cage' (desks) and 'roaring' (noise).

35. A — 'creaked' is an onomatopoeic word that adds suspense.

36. Metaphor/personification — hope is described like a small flame, suggesting it is fragile and could easily go out.

37. B is better — it uses a precise verb ('roared') and personification ('licked'), creating a vivid, powerful image instead of just naming the fire's size and heat.

38. A and C (both give a human action — dancing, smiling — to something non-human).

39. 'as soft as a whisper' — compares the quietness of her voice to a whisper.

40. A — it begins with 'Although…' before the main clause.

41. Example: 'The storm clawed at the windows all night.' (accept any valid personification)

42. 'Snatched' suggests a quick, greedy action — more vivid than a plain verb like 'took'.

43. A and C ('yelled' and 'whispered' are precise alternatives that show how something was spoken).

44. Example: Simile — 'The sunset was as orange as a ripe peach.' Metaphor — 'The sunset was a blazing fire in the sky.' (accept any valid pair)

45. Personification — silence is given the physical ability to 'press', making the quiet feel heavy and almost uncomfortable.

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Easy / Standard

1. C — personification
2. simile
3. alliteration (repeated 'f' sound)
4. B — The ice was as smooth as glass
5. Example: "The car shot past like a bolt of lightning."
6. onomatopoeia — "hissed" and "whistled" imitate the real sounds the kettle makes, making the description vivid
7. "glared" — shows a stronger, more specific emotion (anger/annoyance) than the plain verb "looked"
8. A — Wild winds whipped wildly
9. B and C (flowers "bowed" and the moon "watched" — human actions given to non-human things)
10. B — "Golden flames licked greedily at the logs" — uses personification and a powerful verb to create a vivid image
11. onomatopoeia
12. Example: "Our teacher was a guiding light." (accept any valid metaphor)
13. A — Suddenly, the lights went out
14. personification (the clock tower is given the human action of watching)
15. B and D ("dashed" and "snatched" are precise, vivid verbs; "ran" and "got" are plainer, more general verbs)

Standard

16. Personification gives human qualities/actions to something non- human (e.g. "the wind sang"); a metaphor says one thing IS another thing (e.g. "the wind was a wild beast"). Personification is a specific type of metaphor.
17. B — Her smile was sunshine itself
18. Onomatopoeia — "creaked" imitates the real sound of the gate, adding atmosphere
19. Example: "\"Help me!\" she screamed." / "\"Help me!\" she cried." (accept any powerful alternative to "said")
20. C — Amir punched the air and laughed out loud (shows the physical signs of happiness rather than stating the emotion)
21. A and C (popped and rumbled imitate real sounds; B and D are plain statements)
22. Example: "The breeze tiptoed through the garden, gently kissing the flowers."
23. B — alliteration (repeated 'p' sound)
24. It creates atmosphere and variety by fronting the time clause, instead of the plain, list-like sentence
25. B — "Waves crashed and thundered against the rocks" — uses powerful verbs to create a vivid, dramatic image
26. Simile ("like a wolf") and personification ("tearing at her coat" — giving the wind a violent, deliberate action)
27. A — Across the empty field, the fog crept
28. A and C (both use a fronted adverbial/phrase for variety; B and D start with the plain subject)
29. Example: "His fists clenched and his face turned red as he slammed the door."
30. Personification — the volcano is given human/animal actions (roaring, spitting), making it feel alive and dangerous

Standard / Advanced

31. Personification — the gate is given a human-like groan, making it feel old and tired.
32. Metaphor — her smile is described directly as sunshine, suggesting it was warm and bright.
33. B — it states directly that the classroom IS a zoo, without using 'like' or 'as'.
34. 'Devoured' suggests the dog ate quickly and hungrily — more vivid than a plain verb like 'ate'.
35. Personification — thunder is given the human action of grumbling.
36. Example: 'The old man's shoulders drooped and his eyelids grew heavy.' (accept any valid showing rewrite)

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37. A and C ('crackled', 'hissed' and 'screeched' are all words that imitate sounds).
38. A — 'like a wolf' is the simile, and 'tore' gives the wind a violent, human-like action (personification).
39. B is more effective — it uses specific detail and a simile ('like cymbals') to let the reader picture the chaos, rather than simply naming it.
40. Example: 'The storm roared over the village, rattling every window. Lightning clawed across the sky, and everyone huddled together, frightened.' (accept any answer using a strong verb and a clear technique)
41. Personification — time is given the human ability to 'creep', emphasising how slowly it seemed to pass.
42. A — it begins with 'Because…' before the main clause.
43. Example: Personification — 'The battlefield groaned under the weight of the fallen.' Metaphor — 'The battlefield was a graveyard of broken dreams.' (accept any valid pair)
44. A and C ('dashed' and 'trudged' are precise verbs that show how the action was done).
45. A simply tells the reader the man's feelings using abstract adjectives; B shows the same idea through action and detail, letting the reader infer the emotion, which is more vivid and engaging.

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